

Project Handbook

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Higher Diploma in Computer Science (Level 8)

Department of Computing & Mathematics | SETU Waterford

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Introduction

On this programme Work Placement is optional. **The Project is mandatory and must be completed successfully to graduate.**

As a final year student you are required to create a **capstone project** for your learning on this course.

In terms of size it should reflect the effort of a **15 credit module**.
(i.e. this is a substantial piece of work, way in excess of an assignment)

- Harvard Referencing
- #project channel in Slack
- Ethics Checklist
- DO NOT use sensitive data (create a test data set instead)

Required Artefacts

- Final proposal & Ethics Checklist
 - Academic Document (Final Report)
 - Project Repo with full Git History (code & docs)
 - Implementation Plan (Jira/Trello)
 - Demonstration Video (<10 mins)
 - Poster/Infographic Summary
 - Final Presentation Slides
- Showcase
Project Landing Page

Project Artefacts Breakdown



Documentation

Final proposal, academic document (final report), and showcase details for SETU Expo.



Technical Assets

Single project repo with **full git history**, implementation plan, and hosted landing page.



Media & Visuals

Video demo, poster/infographic, and final presentation slides for the live panel.

. Join the **#project channel in Slack** for mandatory announcements.

1. Project Proposals

Purpose of the Project

- Capstone for learning integration
- Investigate new domains/technologies
- Document work placement
- Showcase skills and achievements
- Formal research in technical domains

Representative Examples

- i. **Work Based Project:** Application or component from placement.
- ii. **Independent Project:** Exploration of a specific domain.
- iii. **Research Paper:** Conference standard paper (Rare).

You will have two meetings in Semester 4 to discuss proposals, complete ethics checklists, and advise on next steps.

Project Marking & Certification

Working in Tech

Choice of work based or independent project.

Recommended:

"Killing 2 birds with 1 stone" by aligning project with work tasks.

Not Working in Tech

Students are incentivised to undertake certification.

Without certification completion, Project mark capped at 70

Certification Options

Free programmes available:

- RedHat, AWS, IBM, Google AI, and Anthropic AI.

Deadline:

3rd week in August after project.

Project Prerequisites



Laptop/Computer



Camera & Mic



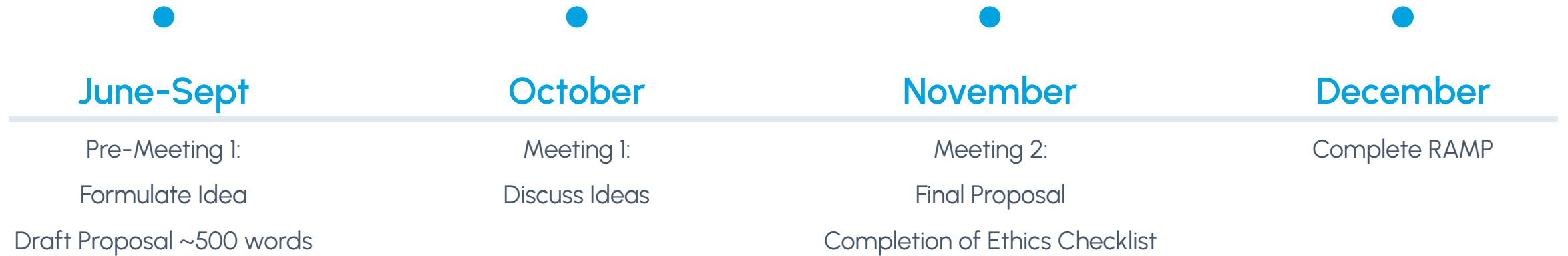
Slack & Zoom Desktop
Apps Installed



Chrome & Firefox

Security permissions for mic and cameras, screen sharing etc. should be granted on your system for all virtual meetings.

i) INCEPTION Phase (June–Nov)



The Online Ethics Checklist:

Must be completed with coordinator after proposal is finalised. **It is inadvisable to proceed without ethical approval.**

ii) RAMP Phase (Nov & Dec)

Research, Analysis, Modelling & Planning

Populate your **Final Report** document during this phase:

- **Research & Analysis:** Requirements, tech, market, repo.
- **Modelling/Design:** Personas, scenarios, wireframes.
- **Methodology:** Agile, Scrum, Kanban, or Hybrid.
- **Plan:** 12-week implementation plan (6 sprints).

Success Tip:

If RAMP is not complete by the end of the year, you will eat into your implementation time in January.

Focus on creating User Stories and defining the MVP.

iii) DEVELOPMENT Phase (Jan-Mar)

This is where you implement the project. Key responsibilities:

- Meet supervisor **weekly** for 30 minutes.
- Maintain an updated Jira/Trello board.
- Submit an **Interim Report** mid-February.
- Host a **Project Landing Page** (Bitly URL required for Expo).
- Full GIT **history** for Code & Documentation

Git History:

Required for code, docs and artefacts. We will not evaluate without it.

iv) DISSEMINATION Phase (April & May)



Final Submissions

Final report (8000 words),
Repo with Git & Doc history,
Demo video (<10 mins),
Infographic
Presentation Slides.

Final projects are archived to provide a repository of member work and assist future students.

<https://expo.setu.ie/#Projects>

Git History:

Required for code, docs and artefacts. We will not evaluate without it.

Project Milestones

Phase	Sem	#	Milestone	When
(i)	4	1	Draft Proposal (Idea)	June-Sept (Before M1)
	4	2	Meeting 1 with Project Coordinator	October
	4	3	Draft Proposal Updated	Before Meeting 2
	4	4	Meeting 2 with Project Coordinator	November
	4	5	Final Proposal	Latest Early December
	4	6	Online Ethical Checklist	Meeting 2
(ii)	4	-	RAMP Phase	Oct, Nov, Dec
(iii)	5	7	Interim Report	Mid-February
	5	8	Showcase Entry (Infographic, Landing Page)	Week 10
	5	9	Final Project Submission (code-complete)	Week 12
(iv)	5	10	Final Report Submission	Code complete +1 day
	5	11	Video demo of project	Code complete +1 week
	5	12	Presentation slides	Code complete +1 week
	5	13	Presentation to judging panel	Code complete +2 weeks
	5	14	Initial Grade	Just Before Expo
	5	15	Presentation at Expo	Before Week 4 in May

3. Project Submissions: Policies

Artefacts created must adhere to SETU Academic Integrity standards:

Policy Framework

- Student Expected Behaviour
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Use of Gen AI Policy

AI Requirement

Transparent use required.

Provide an AI chapter listing tools, evaluations, and **full prompt history**.

Git Requirement

A **full GIT History** is required in your repo for the duration of the project.

Submissions Summary

Ethical Checklist

Vital for project viability.

Without successful completion you cannot submit.

Interim Report

Early draft of final report. Up to **4000 words**. Contains RAMP plus first reflection.

Showcase Entry

Brochure details: headshot, title, 500-char abstract, tech keywords, and landing page URL.

Word count calculations: *Doc words - (appendices + TOC + Bibliography + Headings)*

Final Report Elements

Written in **past tense**. Limit: **8000 words**.

- Cover Page
- Declaration
- Abstract
- Keywords
- TOC / TOF / TOT
- RAMP Section
- Implementation
- AI Section
- Reflection
- Bibliography

"Images don't affect your word count. Use numbered headings and styles."

Appendix 1: Proposal Outline

Required Metadata

- Title (Commercial & Academic)
- Project Type & Category
- Tech Stack list
- Tools & Frameworks list
- Stakeholders identified

Process: Indicate project process (iteration plan). Proposal length: **400-500 words**.

Header must include programme: HDip in Science in Computer Science.

NDA & Word Count

NDA Policy

Facilitates sensitive work projects. **Blanket NDAs are frowned upon.** Must provide reviewable code to panel.

Word Count Strategy

Budget wordcount per section. **Waffle disappears** with strict editing. Within 10% is acceptable.

Declaration: Appendix 5 declaration must be included immediately inside the cover page.

Assessment Breakdown

PART A (85%)

- **Level (25%):** Originality/Complexity.
- **Comm (30%):** Docs, Git, AI, Video.
- **Implementation (30%):** Working system.

PART B (15%)

- What you **learned** (5%).
- What you **achieved** (5%).
- Problems & **Solutions** (5%).

Note: Penalties apply for late submission or exceeding word count.